Valentin Nikolaev

Senior Go Backend Engineer

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Summary

Backend engineer with 15+ years of experience building production systems and recent focus on Go services, APIs, automation platforms, event-driven pipelines, and operational reliability. Combines hands-on delivery with system design, performance optimization, cloud infrastructure, and pragmatic technical leadership. Experienced in taking ownership of business-critical services and collaborating with product, operations, and engineering stakeholders.

Skills

- **Backend:** Go, PHP, REST APIs, Microservices, Event-Driven Systems
- **Cloud & Platform:** AWS, Kubernetes, Helm, CI/CD
- **Data & Messaging:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, Elasticsearch, RabbitMQ
- **Reliability:** Prometheus, Production Reliability

Experience

Simple.life | Software Developer

November 2023 - August 2026

- Designed and owned a Go-based support automation platform connecting Zendesk, Intercom, and internal services through a scalable backend and unified API orchestration layer.
- Integrated automated triage flows that handled or deflected up to 30% of inbound tickets, enabling the support organization to expand automation coverage.
- Migrated business-critical workflows from Zendesk to Intercom's real-time engine and improved routing consistency and operational responsiveness.
- Built resilient message-delivery pipelines with fallback logic, retries, and monitoring to protect customer communication during incidents and peak load.
- Collaborated with Support Operations, Product, and engineering stakeholders to turn operational needs into reliable backend workflows.

Technologies: Go, REST APIs, Zendesk, Intercom, Monitoring, Backend Integrations

airSlate | Senior Software Developer / Technical Lead

February 2021 - August 2023

- Reduced peak load on the main database by removing bottlenecks and redistributing workload, improving stability during high-traffic periods.
- Migrated services from ECS to Kubernetes and prepared the delivery stack with Helm, GitHub Actions, and ArgoCD.
- Implemented CI/CD pipelines, investigated API and query bottlenecks, and troubleshot production issues through logs, monitoring, and SRE dashboards.
- Supported Agile planning, release delivery, task evaluation, and work distribution; conducted more than 20 technical interviews.

Technologies: PHP, Laravel, Symfony, MySQL, Elasticsearch, RabbitMQ, AWS, Kubernetes, Prometheus, Helm, GitHub Actions, ArgoCD

Hyprr | Technical Lead

November 2019 - January 2021

- Helped bring a creator-focused social and digital-asset platform from prototype to closed beta in under six months.
- Managed 10 developers while remaining involved in backend delivery, architecture, project planning, and CI/CD.
- Defined the technology roadmap with the CTO and shaped microservice and serverless architecture, reliability, and serviceability decisions.

Technologies: Go, PHP, Laravel, Mezzio, Phalcon, PostgreSQL, MySQL, AWS, Kubernetes, Microservices, REST APIs, Prometheus, Jaeger

PDFfiller | Software Developer / Backend Team Lead

October 2016 - November 2019

- Led five backend engineers developing a high-volume transactional and lifecycle email service.
- Scaled the service to approximately 50 million emails per month and guided the team through BFCM periods with more than 10x traffic growth.
- Made key technical decisions across delivery and reliability, developing deep expertise in DNS, DKIM, SPF, DMARC, and feedback loops.

Technologies: PHP, Laravel, MySQL, Elasticsearch, RabbitMQ, AWS, REST APIs, Email Infrastructure, SRE

Education

MSc in Computer Science, National Technical University, Kharkiv, Ukraine | 2003 - 2008

Languages

- Ukrainian: Native
- English: Professional working proficiency / Upper-intermediate